LAXMAN KANAGARATNAM

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EDUCATION

University of Vienna

- BSc Physics 2025–present
  Current enrollment status: active
  Enrollment date: 01.10.2025
  Expected graduation: 30.06.2026
  Weighted GPA: 2.48/5 Completed: 125/180 ECTS

- BSc Astronomy 2024–present
  Current enrollment status: active
  Enrollment date: 01.03.2024
  Expected graduation: 30.06.2026
  Weighted GPA: 2.26/5 Completed: 145/180 ECTS

Note: Austrian grading scale (1 = highest grade, 5 = lowest grade)

Other Education

- MIT OpenCourseWare Physics Lectures 2025–present
  Self-study; used to compensate for course schedule conflicts

RESEARCH

Alves Lab, University of Vienna 2025–present

- Bachelor thesis on the large-scale structure in the Vela region using Gaia DR3.
  Applying the `SigMA` clustering algorithm developed by Sebastian Ratzenböck (Postdoctoral Fellow, Harvard University) to identify and characterise stellar groups.
- Supervised by:
  João Alves (Professor, University of Vienna),
  Alena Rottensteiner (PhD Student, University of Vienna) and
  Cameren Swiggum (Postdoctoral Fellow, Harvard University).
- Implemented in Python and maintained openly on GitHub.

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant, University of Vienna confirmed 2026

- Teaching Assistant for Dynamics and Thermodynamics
  supervised by Prof. Kristina Kislyakova and Prof. Glenn van de Ven

Teaching Assistant, Veterinary University of Vienna 2025

- Teaching Assistant for Medical Physics Laboratory
  supervised by Dr. Olga Jovanovic

Teaching Assistant, ETH Zürich 2023

- Teaching Assistant and Senior Coach for Analysis I
  supervised by Prof. Alessio Figalli and Dr. Alexander Caspar

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCES

Academic Community Contributions 2024–present

- Provide detailed semester summaries and exam-preparation notes to the BSc Physics and BSc Astronomy student groups each term, widely used and appreciated by many students.

aCentauri Solar Racing Team at ETH Zurich 2023

- Competitor in the Bridge Stone World Solar Challenge 2023

Physics I Formula Compendium at ETH Zurich 2023

- Co-developed the official LaTeX formula compendium for Physics I supervised by Prof. Werner Wegscheider

Matura Project Exhibitor at the University of Basel 2020

- Presented Matura Project at the Saturday Morning Physics Event supervised by PD Dr. Matthias Liebendörfer

TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

- Python (NumPy, matplotlib, pandas, Astropy), Jupyter, LaTeX, GitHub
- TOPCAT, Simbad, Muniwin, VStar, Minima27

EXTRACURRICULARS

- Private tutor for mathematics and physics
- Former teacher and member of the Chess Club Therwil